

****Cyber War** **Attack happens**.** A coordinated cyberattack targeted over 30 Minnesota community water systems. Result: plant outage, communications failures. Cities affected: Braham, Plymouth, South St. Paul, Maple Plain.

****Hardware security**** matters. ****Supply chain integrity**** too. Most teams assume security, but measures can be bypassed if hardware or supply chain is not secure. We worked with a client implementing ****Zero-Trust**** architecture and realized a single vulnerable component can bring down the system.

Attackers used **RCE** vulnerability or **social engineering** tactics, exploiting a **third-party component** to gain access to sensitive data. Fix it by prioritizing **hardware security** and **supply chain integrity**, designing systems with security in mind, and monitoring the supply chain. **Cyberattack** cost: over \$1 million. As a practitioner, I've seen firsthand how a single misconfigured device can lead to a system-wide breach, and how regular security audits can prevent such incidents. By